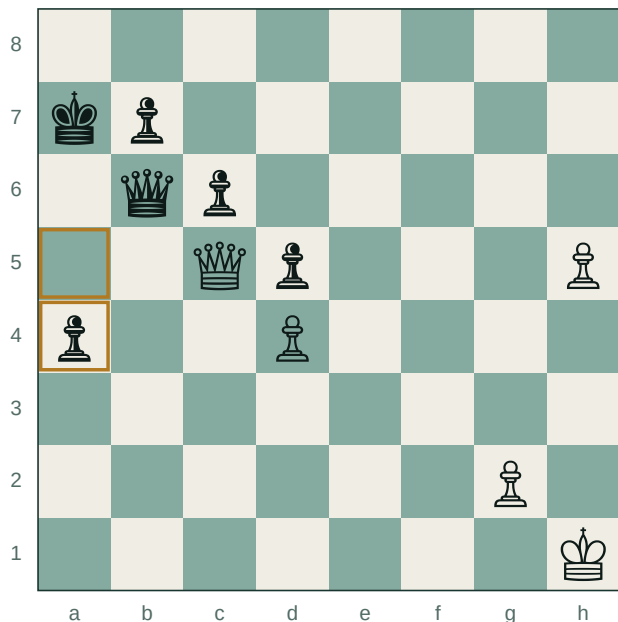


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 46

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 45...a4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

46. h6 Ka6 47. Qxb6+ Kxb6 48. h7

46.h6 The pawn moves from h5 to h6. Recorded reply: **46...Ka6**.

47.Qxb6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the queen on b6. Recorded reply: **47...Kxb6**.

48.h7 The pawn moves from h6 to h7.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on a7. Absolute pin: queen on b6.